word 'bank' can represent the banks of the river or it can represent the place where financial dealings take place. The worldly knowledge that money can be withdrawn from a bank allows us to distinguish that the word 'bank' in this particular case refers to financial institutions (and, thereby, return documents pertaining to banks which facilitate financial transactions) and not to river banks. Thus, there are multiple levels at which NLP can aid IR. We will discuss this further in the next column.

We are all familiar with Twitter and how information is exchanged through short tweets. Here is a takeaway question for our readers. Given that one is interested in finding all relevant tweets related to a popular event or incident, how would you construct an information retrieval system for tweets?

My 'must-read book' for this month

This month's book suggestion comes from one of our readers, Kanthi, and her recommendation is very appropriate for this month's column. She recommends an excellent article on information retrieval titled, 'How Google finds your needle in the Web's haystack' by David Austin and it is available at: *http://www.ams.org/samplings/feature-column/fcarc-pagerank.* This article provides a good description of the page rank algorithm employed by Google to rank the relevant results. Thank you, Kanthi, for sharing this link.

If you have a favourite programming book/article that you think is a must-read for every programmer, please do send me a note with the book's name, and a short write-up on why you think it is useful so I can mention it in the column. This would help many readers who want to improve their software skills.

If you have any favourite programming questions/software topics that you would like to discuss on this forum, please send them to me, along with your solutions and feedback, at *sandyasm_AT_yahoo_DOT_com*. Till we meet again next month, happy programming! END

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